Information Privacy

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CSE362

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Privacy - POV

- There is a tug-of-war between the desires, rights and responsibilities of a person who wants to restrict access to himself, and the desires, rights, and responsibilities of outsiders to gain access.
- We can define privacy in two ways:
  - The POV of an individual seeking to restrict access;
  - The POV of outsiders seeking access

- Do we have the natural right to privacy in the same way that we have the right to own property and the right to liberty?

What is a Digital Footprint?

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- The information about a particular person that exists on the internet as a result of their online activity.
- refers to one's unique set of traceable digital activities, actions, contributions and communications manifested on the Internet or digital devices
- have a lasting impact on your reputation, relationships and employment opportunities

How do we leave behind digital footprints

- Online shopping (Making purchases)
- Creating accounts online
- Online banking
- Using social media
- Logging into websites
- Sharing information, data, and photos with your connections
- Joining a dataing site
- Subscribing to an online news source
- Buying or selling stocks,
- Viewing articles on the web
- Using apps
- **Essentially everything you do online will leave a digital footprint.**

Data Mining

- Process of searching through many records in one or more databases looking for patterns or relationships.
- It can be used as a way of predicting future events.

- What are some positive effects of data mining?
- What are some negative effects of data mining?

My private life revealed on the web

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PxEEu-c0QFw&ab_channel=CNNBusiness

Case Studies

FACEBOOK BEACON (Opt-in, Opt-Out)

- In November 2007, Facebook announced Beacon.
  - Promised to be an important way for facebook to earn advertising revenue.
  - Was based on an opt-out policy.
- The decision to make the syste opt-out upset many facebook users, who were unaware of Beacon until it revealed information they thought it was private.
- For example, after Sean Lane purchased what was supposed to be a surprise Christmas gift, the following news headline was broadcast to his wife and more than 700 other people on his facebook network:
  - "Sean Lane bought 14K White Gold 1/5 ct Diamond Eternity Flower Ring from overstock.com"
- **Was Facebook wrong for doing this? Did they go too far?**

Example of Data Mining

- Target Knows when your pregnant:
  - https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XH1wQEgROg4&ab_channel=WCPO9
- Is this a violation of privacy?

Enhanced 911 Services

- All US cell phone providers are required by law to be able to track the location of active cell phone users to within 100 meters.
  - The safety benefit to this is obvious.
  - Downside: What happens if this information is shared or sold?
  - Potential loss of privacy?

Can you disappear online?

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mhinQV-eTKM&ab_channel=CBS8SanDiego

Steps to help you protect your privacy

- Consider using anonymous search engines designed for privacy, such as DuckDuckGo, or StartPage.
- Consider using a VPN for your internet connections, especially when using a public network;
- Be aware that regardless of what privacy options you set, information about you is being collected, especially on free services, such as Facebook or WhatsApp.
- When creating online accounts, review what information the sites collect about you by checking their Privacy Policy and provide only what you absolutely need to
- Limit what you post and share with others online, such as on public forums or on social media.

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- “With your permission, you give us more information. If you give us information about who some of your friends are, we can probably use some of that information, again, with your permission, to improve the quality of our searches. We don’t need you to type at all, because we know where you are, with your permission. We know where you’ve been, with your permission. We can more or less guess what you’re thinking about.” Eric Schmidt, Former CEO of Google.

THE END